Prayers for our World and the Church
11th October 2026

Psalm 109:30-31

30 With my mouth I will give great thanks to the Lord; I will praise him in the midst of the throng.
31 For he stands at the right hand of the needy one, to save him from those who condemn his soul to death.

As we focus on the shoebox ministry of Operation Christmas Child, let us pray…

Thanks to God

O Lord, we give You great, abundant, overflowing thanks to You today, for we have received so much love poured out on us. You demonstrated Your love for us while we were still sinners by sending Jesus to take our place on the Cross, so t hat we did not have to pay the impossible penalty for our willful disobedience. We thank You that with Jesus, You have blessed us abundantly both spiritually and materially, as we live comfortably in relative peace and prosperity.

We also thank You that we can put together these shoeboxes and fill them with compact tokens of our love for children whom we do not know, but whom You want to know – children who may not have heard the Good News and do not know how You love them.

We thank You for all the contributions that we have brought to fill the shoeboxes, and for Gaye and all the volunteers who have packed them ready for delivery. We thank You for Samaritan's Purse and their organisation.

We pray for safe transport of the collected shoeboxes, for the entire process of getting them to the children will receive them. We pray for the missionaries who will tell of Jesus, Who still draws the children to Himself. And we pray for their families, so that their parents also may know You love and care for them, whatever their circumstances.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

As well as the wide world where we see so much troiuble, opposition and outright persecution, we pray for the church in Australia, which also declares Your Word to those around us, who do not know the Truth. We pray our nation to turn back to You, instead of putting their hope in the plans of man.

Ashburton

We pray for our work here at Ashburton, and we give You thanks again for Your many blessings which allow us to bless others. We thank You for Brett Cummins as he prepares to teach us at the Camp next week, and we thank You for Leighton who brings us Your Word for today.

We pray for the Selection Committee to be encouraged, as they seek Your will, so that in due time we call a new minister of Your choosing.

We look forward to a time of rich fellowship and learning at Camp, so that we may encourage one another to love and good works, and expand our faithful witness to those around us in the communities where we live, work and study.

In His Precious Name we pray, Amen.